



the basic
idea

does free
will explain
any evil?

A large orange circle with a slight drop shadow, containing the text "does free will explain all evil?" in white, bold, sans-serif font.

**does free
will explain
all evil?**

Could we reject (2) instead?

While this sounds odd at first, it fits with an intuitive thought about free will. It is tempting to say that while it is possible for me to freely scratch my nose in a minute, it is not possible for God to bring it about that I freely scratch my nose in a minute — since, if God brought it about, then my nose scratching would not be free.

But this is just a way of denying (2)
— which is (2') in the argument
from pointless evil 2.0 — since it
amounts to saying that there is a
certain possible scenario that God
cannot bring about.

1. It is possible for all people to have free will and yet never bring about any evil.
2. God can bring about any possible situation.

C. God could have made a world where all people have free will and yet never bring about any evil. (1,2)

MACKIE'S ARGUMENT AGAINST THE FWD

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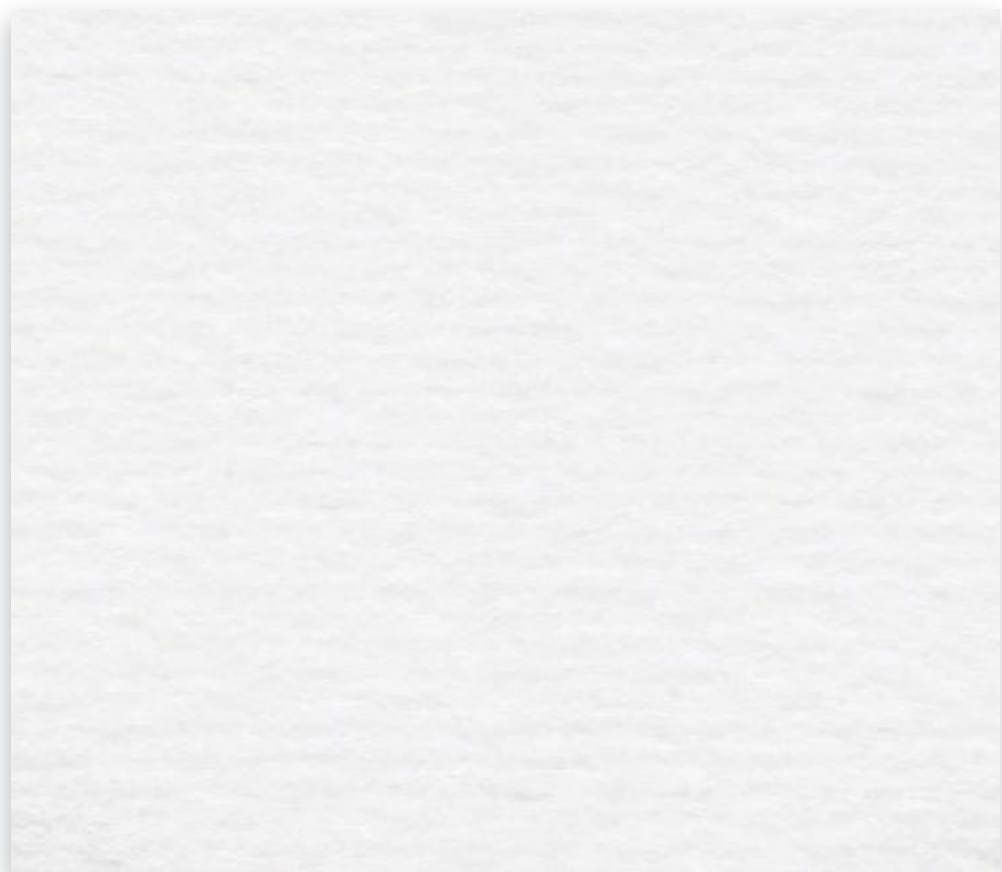
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C. Good have made a

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2. God can bring about any

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eval(1,2)

about any evil.

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there could be evil in a world with a omnipotent and perfectly good

God. It can explain that, it seems, if we make the following assumption:

Summing up so far: we have seen that Frege will promise to explain how

there are possible
situations which an
omnipotent
being cannot
bring about



we have
free will



free will is
a great good

the ability
to harm others
is a great good

does free
will explain
any evil?

A large, solid orange circle with a subtle drop shadow, centered on a white background. Inside the circle, the text "does free will explain all evil?" is written in white, lowercase, sans-serif font, arranged in three lines.

does free
will explain
all evil?

**Free will
cannot
explain any
evil.**

Free will can explain some evil; but it can't explain all of the evil we find in the world.



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1. It is possible for all people to

bringing about any evil.

Ch. Goodbye and Goodnight

possible situation.

where all people have free will

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